

Masters assignment

Questioning

Assignment tips

- Use a range of relevant sources in your literature research and reference them properly
- Proofread – you and another person
- Keep it relevant and focused on your chosen lesson and on questioning
- Criticality
- PEE

Assignment brief

Essay Task (4,500 words):

Questioning is an essential teaching method to consolidate pupils' learning: with reference to a lesson which you have taught and drawing upon educational theory and research and other professional evidence, critically evaluate how you effectively used questioning to consolidate pupils' learning.

Appendices (1,500 words equivalent):

Should include:

- Lesson plan
- Your reflection on the lesson
- Feedback from your mentor/class teacher.
- These should be referred to within the body of your assignment to exemplify what you are saying in your discussion.

Introduction

- Context – school, lesson
- Keep it relevant
- Summarise your use of questioning in the chosen lesson - your overarching argument – your answer to the essay question
- The overarching argument should be targeted – which year group, which subject, which attainment level etc.

Main body of the assignment

- Mini arguments (around 3) that make up your overarching argument
- Structure each paragraph around a mini argument.
 - Include evidence, theory, and research. Expand your point through evaluation, not just description.
- Answer the “How” and “Why”. Explain why you made certain choices and how they relate to learning and pedagogy.
- Critically engage with literature.
 - Who wrote it? When was it published? How was the research done? (Qualitative vs. quantitative – neither is automatically superior.) What type of source is it? (Peer-reviewed research > think pieces or non-academic sources.) What is their position? Compare different viewpoints.
- Take a position – but be tentative
 - Use cautious language: perhaps, may, should rather than bold claims like must. Acknowledge uncertainty – we rarely have absolute answers in education.

Masters level writing

- Spend more time in 'how' or 'why' rather than 'what' (descriptive).
- Avoid being too descriptive or repetitive.
- Plan it well and it writes itself.
- Quality of sources: Prefer robust, peer-reviewed literature. If using smaller or less rigorous studies, acknowledge their limitations.
- A lot of the Literature should be robust (regardless as to whether you agree with it). If it's not robust it should at least align with what you're trying to say and can acknowledge it's a small study or whatever.
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Example overarching argument

In this Year 9 mixed-attainment Chemistry lesson on the Reactivity Series, I argue that the strategic use of **hinge-point questions** and **targeted 'cold-calling'** served as the primary mechanism for consolidating learning. While these methods effectively identified and addressed the 'displacement' misconception in the moment, their success was contingent upon a classroom culture that prioritised 'wait time,' suggesting that questioning is most effective when it balances cognitive challenge with psychological safety.

To build your **mini-arguments** from here, you might structure your paragraphs like this:

- 1. Mini-argument 1:** How cold-calling increased participation and revealed specific misconceptions.
- 2. Mini-argument 2:** How hinge-point questions allowed you to pivot the lesson based on real-time data.
- 2. Mini-argument 3:** An evaluation of the limitations (e.g., how the pressure of questioning might have hindered lower-attainment students if not for the "wait time").